



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 28

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Hand Protection: Choosing the Right Glove

OVERVIEW:

Gloves are one of the most-used and most-misused pieces of PPE in the trades. Many workers wear whatever gloves are available regardless of the hazard, which can provide false protection or create new hazards. Matching the glove to the specific hazard is as important as wearing gloves in the first

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Cut-resistant gloves are rated using the ANSI/ISEA 105 standard, which classifies cut resistance from Level A1 through Level A9. For handling sheet goods, lumber with rough edges, and glass, a minimum of Level A4 cut resistance is appropriate. Higher levels provide more protection but reduce dexterity. Choose the highest level of cut resistance that still allows you to perform the task —
2. Nitrile gloves are the correct choice for chemical work — adhesives, stains, lacquers, solvents, and epoxy components. Nitrile provides good resistance to a wide range of chemicals that latex does not resist. However, nitrile is not impervious — for extended contact with aggressive solvents, check the specific chemical resistance chart for your glove, as breakthrough times vary
3. This is critical and applies in our trade every single day: never wear gloves near rotating equipment. This means table saws, router tables, drill presses, lathes, and any other machine with a rotating component that can catch fabric. A glove caught in a spinning bit, blade, or shaft does not give the hand time to pull free — the hand goes with the glove. No gloves near rotating cutting
4. Leather gloves are appropriate for heavy material handling — moving rough lumber bundles, handling heavy hardware, and general rigging work. They provide abrasion resistance and modest cut resistance but poor chemical protection. If you are switching between material handling and chemical application tasks, change gloves between tasks. Cross-contaminating chemical exposure with

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What gloves do we have available on this job, and are they the right types for the work we are doing today?
- Q2: Has anyone been injured because they were or were not wearing gloves? Walk through what happened.

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Cut-resistant gloves for sheet goods, lumber handling, and glass work
- Nitrile gloves for all adhesives, finishes, and chemical products
- Never wear gloves near rotating equipment — they can pull a hand in
- Inspect gloves before every use — holes defeat the purpose entirely
- Match the glove to the hazard — check SDS for chemical compatibility

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 28

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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